

Brainstorming & Idea Prioritization

Date: 11 June 2026

Project Name: E-commerce Application

Step 1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement

Problem Statement:

Small and medium-sized businesses struggle to set up and manage an online storefront efficiently, while customers desire a seamless, fast, and secure shopping experience with robust search, filters, and multiple payment options.

Step 2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

Idea Listing:

1. Custom-built MERN stack application for full control.
2. Use Shopify or WooCommerce (Discarded: lack of customizability).
3. JWT-based authentication for secure sessions.
4. Integrate a Payment Gateway for global/local payments.
5. Cloudinary for optimized image storage.
6. Role-based access control (Admin vs. User).
7. Interactive Admin Dashboard with sales metrics.
8. Persistent Shopping Cart using MongoDB.

Grouping:

- *Core Architecture:* MERN stack, JWT Auth, Role-based access.
- *Customer Experience:* Persistent Cart, Payment Gateways (Payment Gateway (Planned)).
- *Admin & Operations:* Admin Dashboard, Cloudinary Integration.

Step 3: Idea Prioritization

- **High Priority / Must Have:** User Authentication, Product Catalog (CRUD), Shopping Cart, Checkout flow, Payment Integration.
- **Medium Priority / Should Have:** Admin Dashboard charts, Payment Gateway, Reviews and Ratings.
- **Low Priority / Could Have:** Advanced product recommendations, wishlist.